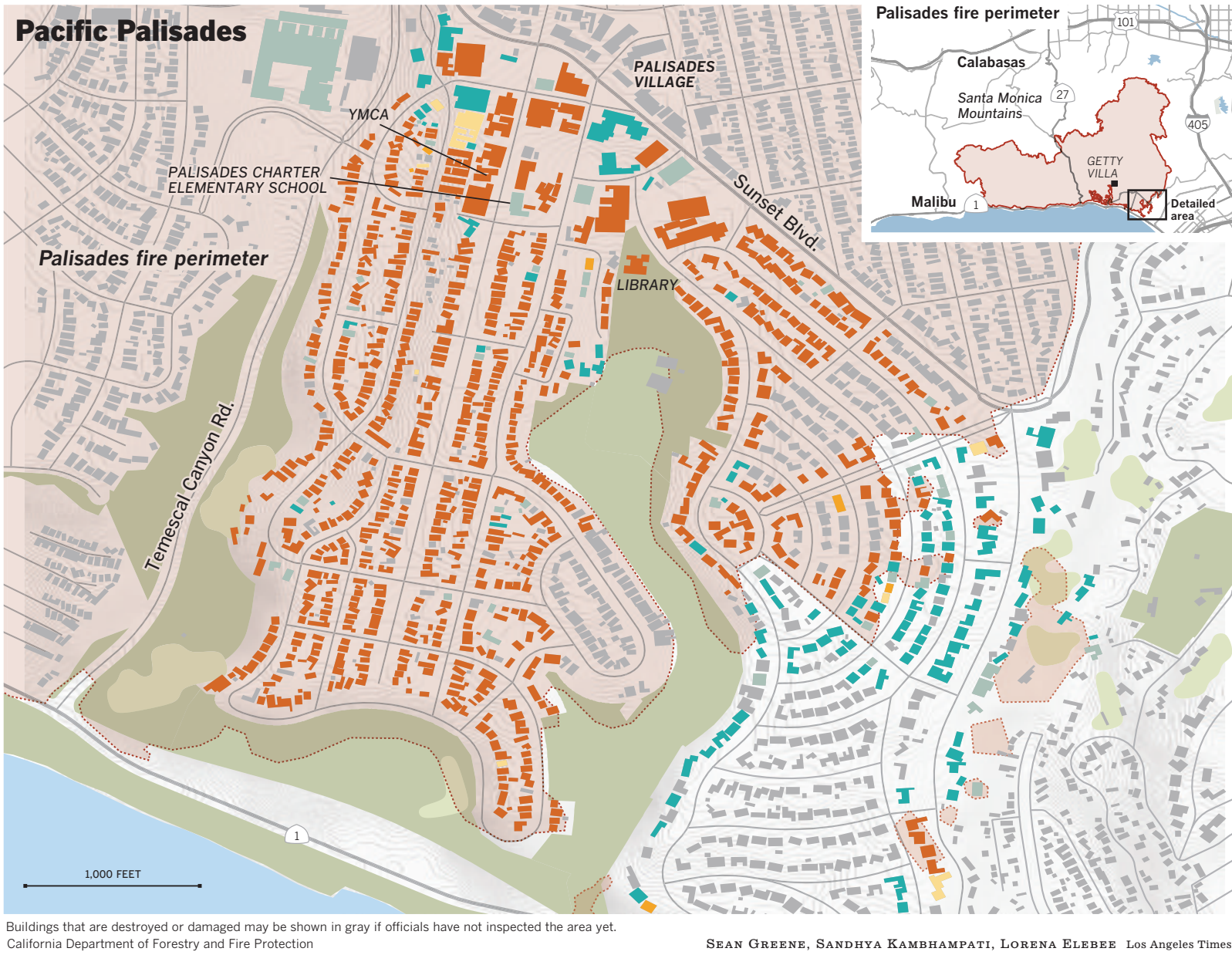
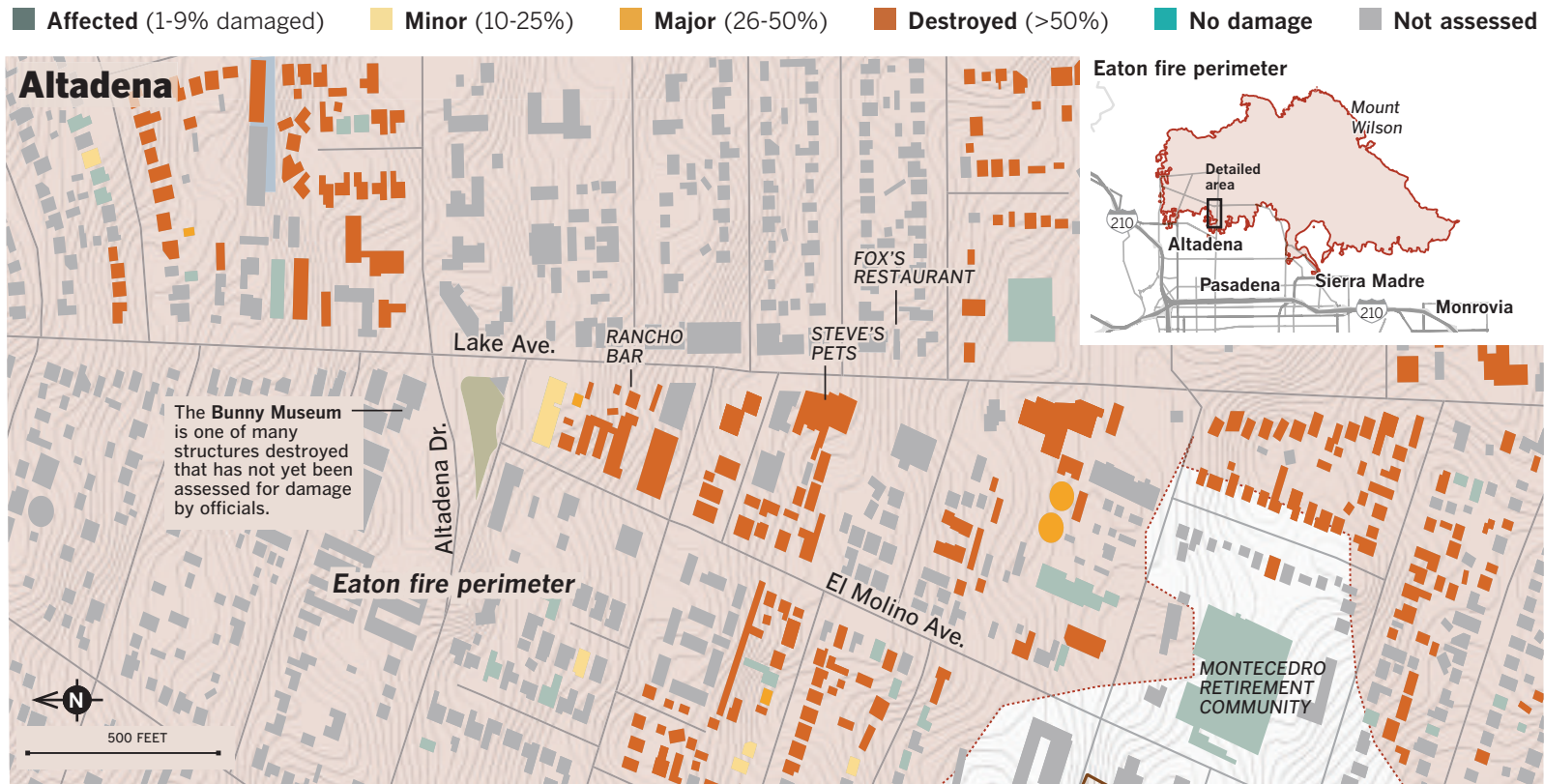


Mapping the damage from the Eaton and Palisades fires

The Los Angeles area’s unprecedented firestorm consumed nearly 40,000 acres in Altadena and Pacific Palisades. These maps reflect only a fraction of the structures lost as damage assessments on the ground continue. To find our periodically updated maps, visit [latimes.com](#).

Damaged or destroyed structures inspected as of noon, Jan. 16



Buildings that are destroyed or damaged may be shown in gray if officials have not inspected the area yet.
California Department of Forestry and Fire Protection

SEAN GREENE, SANDHYA KAMBHAMPATI, LORENA ELEBEE Los Angeles Times

L.A.’S BATTLE FOR WATER

As the Palisades fire exploded, the DWP struggled to keep the flow going.

BY MATT HAMILTON AND IAN JAMES

As wildfire tore through the canyons of Pacific Palisades, firefighters waged a desperate battle to save homes and lives.

Seventeen miles east in downtown L.A., dozens of officials huddled around computers over a long conference room table in the Los Angeles Department of Water and Power’s emergency operations center. Screens beamed in the system’s water pressure from remote sensors stationed across the city.

With more firefighters rushing to tame the flames that afternoon of Jan. 7, it became increasingly apparent that the Palisades needed more water, fast.

In the tanks that regulate pressure in the upper reaches of the canyons, water was beginning to dwindle. DWP officials had to figure out how to boost pressure into the western reaches of the grid, where a 36-inch pipeline ferries water from a Bel-Air reservoir to the Westside before curving uphill into the Palisades Highlands.

They wrestled with a high-stakes choice: shut off water to nearby neighborhoods such as Brentwood, or face diminishing water pressure on the front lines.

Without water, dialysis centers and other medical facilities would be impaired. How long would it take to turn off valves safely? Could the pipes handle such a shift, or might they rupture?

As the inferno swelled, [See DWP, A7]

A respite before danger returns

BY RONG-GONG LIN II AND HANNAH FRY

Winds are expected to continue dissipating this week, but it’s shaping up to be a short reprieve for fire-scarred Southern California.

There’s a growing risk that significant fire weather could return in Los Angeles and Ventura counties starting early next week. But even more than winds, the region faces danger from extreme dry conditions and lack of rain.

Relative humidity could fall into the single digits next week, intensifying the risk that a spark hitting dry vegetation could result in a fast-moving conflagration, particularly if winds kick up again.

“You can’t get much more dry than what we’re experiencing right now,” said Capt. Sergio Arellano, a spokesperson for the California Department of Forestry and Fire Protection. “If there’s any heat introduced to these fuels — to these grasses — it could be catastrophic.”

Southern California is seeing one of its driest starts [See Fires, A8]

DAVID LYNCH, 1946 - 2025

Visionary filmmaker with eye for surreal

BY ALEXANDRA DEL ROSARIO

David Lynch, the visionary filmmaker known for “Twin Peaks” and “The Elephant Man,” was an artist in more than one sense of the word.

He was an experimental rocker and sound designer whose compositions and collaborations supplemented the signature dreamlike qualities of his beloved screen projects.

He was also an abstract painter, photographer and sculptor whose prints and constructions echoed the underlying discomfort that was constant in “Mulholland Drive” and “Blue Velvet.” Lynch’s enthusiasm for art seemingly knew no bounds.

“There’s a connection between music, film, painting, writing, everything,” Lynch told The Times in 1999. “I guess the more [things] you’re into, the more they’re going to help each other.”

The result of this approach was Lynch’s confounding [See Lynch, A6]

A survivor’s guilt amid the ashes

Feeling grateful that wildfire spared his Altadena home, yet the scars linger

BILL PLASCHKE

I lost nothing. I lost everything.

I am lucky beyond all imagination. I am haunted beyond all reason.

I am spared. Nobody is spared.

I am rounding the sharp turn that enters my leafy Altadena cul-de-sac, my home for the last dozen years, and I am loudly pleading.



“Hail Mary, full of grace ...”

It is a Wednesday morning, several hours after the Eaton fire began tearing apart thousands of lives, and there are still flames shooting up from burning destruction. On every block, the air is still dark with smoke and the streets are still clogged with trees, but my fiancée, Roxana, and I had just endured a night of sleepless terror. We had to come here. We had to see.

Did we lose this most evil of lotteries? Did we take a direct hit from the hand of hell?

The long-term health effects of wildfire smoke

BY TONY BRISCOE

The explosion of smoke and ash that erupted from two wildfires was beyond belief.

In the foothills of the San Gabriel Mountains, as the Eaton fire engulfed homes and businesses, a thick blanket of smoke rolled over the horizon, blocking out the

sun.

The wildfires produced the heaviest smoke and soot the region has seen in recent memory.

On Jan. 8, an air monitor in Chinatown — about 10 miles downwind of the Eaton fire — recorded 483.7 micrograms per cubic meter of fine particulate matter, according to preliminary [See Smoke, A9]



JASON ARMOND Los Angeles Times
THE LOT at Santa Anita Park in Arcadia is open until 9 p.m. Friday as a donation site for fire victims.

MORE FIRE COVERAGE INSIDE

Young climate scientist helped warn Altadena

He urged some residents early on to pack their bags and get ready to evacuate. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Edison stock volatile amid wildfire scrutiny

The catastrophic inferno in L.A. County has rocked the shares of SCE’s parent firm. **BUSINESS, A12**

Academy CEO says Oscars will proceed

Ceremony “must go forward” on March 2 and will honor first responders. **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**

Weather

Foggy, then sunny.
L.A. Basin: 61/44. **B6**



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